

creativity with technical learning.

We're used to thinking of Linux distributions being set in stone. They're either KDE or Gnome, use a certain kernel and bundle certain applications. But this doesn't have to be the case. You find yourself making the same adjustments each time you do a fresh install.

Making your own customised Linux distro is simpler than you might think – and rewarding too. Don your overalls and hard hat, and we'll show you how to start building your ideal distro. There are three basic ways to roll

yours, depending on the scope of what you want to accomplish and the level of technical expertise you have to bring to the project. The first, easiest, and possibly the most immediately useful to most people, is remastering a live CD. The second, and possibly the most flexible being respinning an already installed and customised system into a distro. And the third, and definitely the most hardcore and closest to 'Creating your own Linux distro' is LinuxFromScratch.

4.1 Remastering a live CD

Now, although it is possible to create a distro from scratch (see the Linux From Scratch section at the end if you want to try), it's generally better to start with a base distro. Apart from getting a head start, there are other reasons to hang on the coat-tails of another distro, and probably the biggest is package

Why create your own distro?

- You can easily build a personalised live CD by including software that does not normally come with Ubuntu.
- You are doing a presentation of a piece of software that runs on Ubuntu, and you want to put your software on a live CD to take with you to show how it works.
- You are installing Ubuntu on multiple machines and once you install Ubuntu, you always have to install specific software and drivers to configure your Ubuntu installation.
- You want to make a small Ubuntu live CD with your specific software to take with you wherever you go. This can be useful if you are in college and often use libraries or internet cafes.
- You want to create a 'Media-centric live CD' with proprietary codecs that can play various media formats, or a live CD that concentrates on a specific purpose or functionality such as games or desktop publishing, complete with topic-related applications.